MetaProcedure — DocLine WhatsApp / Meta Cloud API

Product: DocLine / GlucoGuide
Audience: Ops, engineering, product
Purpose: Complete process to start Meta and go live with clinic WhatsApp booking
Related docs: WhatsApp-How-It-Works.md · Whatsapp-Meta-Rules.md · WhatsApp-Complete-Guide.md

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1. Mental model

```
Patient → Clinic WhatsApp # → Meta Cloud API → DocLine webhook → Bot → Reply
```

DocLine is the **Tech Provider**:

Piece	Model
Meta Developer App	**One** for the platform
Webhook	**One** URL for all clinics
WABA at scale	**One WABA per clinic** (Embedded Signup)
Routing	By `phone_number_id`

The doctor does **not** turn on the bot by scanning a QR. Patients message a **connected LIVE** clinic number; Meta forwards messages to your server.

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2. Choose onboarding path

Path	When	How
A. Pool (pilot ≤ ~20)	First 3–5 clinics	Platform-owned numbers on a WABA; admin assigns
B. Embedded Signup (scale)	N clinics (DoubleTick-style)	Clinic taps **Connect with Meta** → own WABA + Phone Number ID

Complete **Phases 3–5 once**, then use A and/or B per clinic.

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3. Phase 1 — Meta Business (one-time)

1. Create or use a **Meta Business** account → business.facebook.com
2. Complete **Business Verification**
3. Open developers.facebook.com → **Create App** → type **Business**
4. Add product: **WhatsApp**
5. Record **App ID** and **App Secret**
6. Create a **System User** (Business Settings → Users → System users)
7. Assign WhatsApp assets; generate a **permanent token** with:
   - `whatsapp_business_management`
   - `whatsapp_business_messaging`
8. *(Optional for pool)* Create a platform **WABA** and register numbers; note each **Phone Number ID**

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4. Phase 2 — Embedded Signup (N clinics)

1. In the Meta app, configure **Embedded Signup**
2. Create a signup configuration → copy **Configuration ID**
3. For WhatsApp Business app **coexistence** (doctor keeps Business app + bot), set feature:

- `whatsapp_business_app_onboarding`

4. Store values in DocLine `.env` (Phase 3)

DocLine UI

- Clinic: Practice → Billing → **Connect with Meta**
- Ops: `/admin/whatsapp/signup`

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5. Phase 3 — DocLine environment

Set in root / `backend` `.env` (see `.env.example`):

```
# Meta Cloud API
WHATSAPP_ACCESS_TOKEN=<system user permanent token>
WHATSAPP_VERIFY_TOKEN=<any secret string you invent>
WHATSAPP_APP_SECRET=<Meta App Secret>
WHATSAPP_API_VERSION=v21.0

# Optional defaults for pool
WHATSAPP_PHONE_NUMBER_ID=<pool phone number id if any>
WHATSAPP_WABA_ID=<platform waba id if any>

# Embedded Signup (Connect with Meta)
META_APP_ID=<app id>
META_APP_SECRET=<app secret>
META_EMBEDDED_SIGNUP_CONFIG_ID=<embedded signup config id>
META_EMBEDDED_SIGNUP_FEATURE=whatsapp_business_app_onboarding

# OCR / voice (optional)
OPENAI_API_KEY=
# or HF_TOKEN=
```

Restart **backend on port 3001**.

Check readiness: **Admin → WhatsApp signup** (`/admin/whatsapp/signup`) — config checklist should be green.

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6. Phase 4 — Webhook (one URL for all clinics)

Public HTTPS must reach the DocLine API (e.g. `https://api.yourdomain.com`).

Field	Value
Callback URL	`https://<API_HOST>/api/v1/procto/whatsapp/webhook`
Verify token	Same as `WHATSAPP_VERIFY_TOKEN`
Subscribe	`messages`, `message_template_status_update` (+ ideally `account_update`, `phone_number_quality_update`)

Path in Meta: App → WhatsApp → Configuration → Webhook → Verify & Save.

Local: tunnel `:3001` with ngrok (or similar), use that HTTPS URL as callback.

Signature: Meta sends `X-Hub-Signature-256` ; DocLine verifies with `WHATSAPP_APP_SECRET` .

Routing: One webhook for all clinics. DocLine routes by `metadata.phone_number_id` .

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7. Phase 5 — Templates (UTILITY only)

DocLine submits **10 UTILITY** templates after connect (catalog: `whatsapp.metaTemplates.ts`).

Situation	Allowed
Patient messaged within **24 hours**	Free-form session bot replies
Outside 24h / first outbound reminder	**APPROVED** template only

Ban risks (absolute):

1. Never send free-form proactive alerts outside the 24h window — use templates
2. Never miscategorize MARKETING as UTILITY
3. Honour **STOP** / **START**
4. No medical advice on the bot
5. Disclose AI on first reply
6. Never send passwords or card data on WhatsApp

Meta may take **1–3 business days** for display name + template approval. DocLine marks the line LIVE immediately for session bot; proactive reminders need Meta approval.

Full policy: **Whatsapp-Meta-Rules.md**

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8. Phase 6 — First clinic go-live

1. Clinic on **Starter+** (or admin **Start trial** under Clinics)
2. Connect the number:
   - **Signup:** Practice → Billing → Connect with Meta
     (or Admin `/admin/whatsapp/signup`)
   - **Pool:** Admin → WhatsApp → assign pool number → LIVE
3. DocLine stores **WABA ID + Phone Number ID** and marks the line **LIVE**
4. Share with patients: `https://wa.me/91XXXXXXXXXX`

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9. Phase 7 — Smoke tests

Use a **patient** phone (not doctor / staff):

Test	Expect
`HELP`	Menu / welcome
`BOOK` / `REGISTER`	Booking / signup flow
Voice note	STT → same as text (if keys set)
ID photo	OCR → confirm registration
`STOP`	Opt out of proactive alerts

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10. Recommended work order

```
1. Meta Business + App + System User token
2. Fill WHATSAPP_* + META_* in .env → restart API
3. Expose API → set webhook → Verify
4. Embedded Signup config ID → Connect with Meta works in UI
```

```
5. Trial/subscribe one clinic → Connect → HELP test
6. Wait Meta template/display-name approval for reminders
7. Onboard more clinics via /admin/whatsapp/signup
```

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11. Local dry run (no Meta)

Leave Meta vars blank → MOCK / `POST /api/v1/procto/whatsapp/webhook/test` still exercises the bot. Real patient WhatsApp requires Phases 1–4.

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12. Admin surfaces

Surface	Path
Partner dashboard (N-number signup)	`/admin/whatsapp/signup`
Pool ops (pilot)	`/admin/whatsapp`
Clinic self-serve	Practice → Billing → Connect with Meta
Trial accounts	Admin → Clinics → Start trial account

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13. Platform go-live checklist

- ☐ Meta Business verified
- ☐ App + System User permanent token
- ☐ Embedded Signup config (+ coexistence if needed)
- ☐ `WHATSAPP_*` / `META_*` set; API restarted on `:3001`
- ☐ Webhook verified on production URL
- ☐ Admin WhatsApp signup checklist green

Per clinic

- ☐ Starter+ or trial active
- ☐ Connect with Meta completed (or pool assigned)
- ☐ Phone Number ID stored; status LIVE
- ☐ Display name approved in WhatsApp Manager
- ☐ Templates APPROVED for proactive alerts (Meta)
- ☐ HELP / BOOK / STOP tests passed
- ☐ wa.me link shared

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14. Common questions

Do patients need QR?
No. They can save the clinic number and message normally. QR only opens chat faster.

Will scanning QR turn on the bot for the doctor?
No.

Can the bot run on personal WhatsApp without Meta?
No. The number must be on Meta's Business platform.

One number per doctor or per clinic?
One number per clinic (practice). All doctors in that clinic share it.

One webhook for all clinics?
Yes. Route by Phone Number ID.
